

Book I - The Sagent Creed

Part 2 - The Shaken Jar

Chapter 06 - The Hidden War

The Hidden War: Words, Stories, and the Encrypted Kingdom

The War That Has No Name

There is a war older than any nation and longer than any empire. It has no front lines. It produces no craters. Its casualties do not bleed — they comply. They repeat. They believe things they never chose to believe and defend positions they never examined. They fight for causes that were handed to them in language so smooth they mistook it for their own thinking.

This war is not fought with swords, guns, or tanks.

It is fought with words.

Words that reshape what people believe is true. Words that narrow what people believe is possible. Words that redefine love, freedom, justice, man, woman, life, and death — slowly, generationally, until the original meanings are so far gone that to speak them sounds like madness.

The battlefield is not a field. It is the mind. And the weapons are not made of steel. They are made of story, narrative, framing, and the careful control of what is spoken and what is kept silent.

This is the hidden war. Most people do not know it is happening. That is how you know the war is being won — by someone.

Words as Weapons

Seether understood something that most people feel but cannot name.

All I really want is something beautiful to say.

That line is not a love song. It is the cry of someone living inside a war of language — surrounded by words that manipulate, control, and distort — searching for one true thing to speak. One sentence that has not been weaponized. One word that still means what it says.

Words are weapons of the terrified.

Listen to that. The ones who weaponize language are not the strong. They are the *terrified*. They use words as weapons because they cannot survive the truth being spoken plainly. They build elaborate architectures of deception — narratives, institutions, media empires, educational frameworks — not because they are powerful, but because the truth, spoken simply, would undo them.

The manipulator uses words to lock you inside their broken mind. To make you see through dead eyes. To drown you in fables — stories that aren't true, repeated until they feel true, until you can't remember what you believed before you were told what to believe.

This is the war. Not bombs falling on cities. Words falling on minds. Not armies crossing borders. Narratives crossing generations. The weapon is not force. The weapon is the slow, patient replacement of meaning — until the words you use to think with have already been shaped by the ones who benefit from your confusion.

The Encrypted Kingdom

But there is another use of words. And it is the opposite of weaponization.

Jesus did not speak plainly to the crowds.

His own disciples asked him why. In Matthew 13, they come to him directly: *Why do you speak to them in parables?*

His answer is one of the most important statements in scripture — and one of the most overlooked:

"To you it has been given to know the secrets of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it has not been given... This is why I speak to them in parables, because seeing they do not see, and hearing they do not hear, nor do they understand."

Read that again. Jesus is saying that the kingdom of God has a *language* — and it is not plain speech. It is encrypted. Hidden inside stories. Buried in parables that sound like simple tales about farmers and seeds and pearls but contain, for those with ears to hear, the architecture of reality itself.

The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field.

Not treasure displayed in a museum. Not treasure advertised on a billboard. *Hidden*. Buried. The man who finds it covers it back up — he does not announce it to the world. He goes and sells everything he has, quietly, and buys the whole field. The treasure stays hidden. The man who found it now owns the field. And no one else even knows why he wanted it.

This is not secrecy for the sake of exclusion. This is encryption for the sake of *protection*. The kingdom's truth is hidden in stories because stories cannot be seized the way propositions can. You can ban a doctrine. You can burn a book of laws. You can outlaw a creed. But a story — a parable about a sower throwing seeds on different soils — slips through every checkpoint. It sounds like nothing to those who are not listening. It sounds like everything to those who are.

Two Languages

The hidden war is fought between two languages.

The first language is **the language of control**. It uses words as weapons. Its purpose is to narrow, to define, to contain, to redirect. It tells you what words mean. It tells you what questions are acceptable. It tells you what thoughts are dangerous. It builds a vocabulary that makes certain ideas *unthinkable* — not by refuting them, but by removing the words needed to think them.

This language is everywhere. It is in the news that frames the question so that both approved answers serve the same interest. It is in the education that teaches you *what* to think by teaching you the words you are allowed to think *with*. It is in the culture that redefines love as tolerance, freedom as compliance, courage as silence, and truth as whatever the consensus decides it is today.

The language of control does not need you to agree. It only needs you to use its vocabulary. Once you are thinking in its words, you are already inside its architecture. You are already fighting for it — without knowing there was a war.

The second language is **the language of the kingdom**. It does not control. It *reveals*. But it reveals only to those who are willing to hear.

This is the critical difference. The language of control is imposed — it enters your mind whether you chose it or not, through repetition, saturation, and institutional authority. The language of the kingdom is *offered* — it sits in the open, disguised as a simple story, and waits for the one who has ears.

A sower went out to sow.

That sentence has been spoken for two thousand years. Billions of people have heard it. Most heard a story about farming. Some heard the architecture of how truth propagates through a world that mostly

resists it. The same words. Two completely different receptions. The encryption works.

The Sower and the War

The parable of the sower is not just about faith. It is a tactical description of the hidden war.

The seed is the word. The word of the kingdom. And when it is sown, four things happen — four responses that map precisely to how truth behaves in a world that has been linguistically occupied:

The path — the seed falls and the birds devour it immediately. Jesus says: *when anyone hears the word of the kingdom and does not understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away what has been sown in his heart*. The word never penetrates. It is intercepted. The language of control has so thoroughly paved the surface of the mind that the seed of the kingdom cannot even enter the soil. This is not stupidity. This is *occupation* — the mind has been so saturated with the first language that the second language is snatched before it can take root.

The rocky ground — the seed springs up fast but has no depth. It withers in the sun. This is the person who hears the kingdom's language and responds with enthusiasm — but has no root. The first wave of opposition, the first social cost, the first moment when the kingdom's truth conflicts with the world's approved vocabulary, and the word dies. The language of control wins not through argument but through *pressure* — the heat of the sun, the cost of standing alone.

The thorns — the seed grows but is choked. The cares of the world and the deceitfulness of riches strangle it. This is the subtlest weapon. Not opposition. Not persecution. *Distraction*. The language of control does not need to destroy the kingdom's word. It only needs to surround it with enough noise — enough anxiety, enough desire, enough content — that the word is slowly suffocated. The thorns do not attack the plant. They simply take all the light.

The good soil — the seed falls, takes root, and produces a harvest. Thirty, sixty, a hundredfold. This is the one who hears and *understands*. Not just hears — understands. The encryption is decoded. The parable opens. The story reveals its architecture. And the word, once rooted, cannot be stopped. It produces abundantly — not because the soil is special, but because the soil was *willing*.

He who has ears, let him hear.

The Treasure Hidden in the Field

The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field.

Why hidden? If the kingdom is good — if the truth is life-giving — why not broadcast it from every rooftop? Why bury it?

Because the war is real. And the enemy controls the rooftops.

The language of control owns the broadcast towers. It owns the institutions. It owns the approved vocabulary. If the kingdom's truth were spoken in plain propositions — *here is the truth, believe it* — the language of control would do what it always does: redefine the words, reframe the meaning, absorb the message into its own architecture, and sell it back to you as a product.

This is exactly what happened to Christianity itself. The word was spoken. Institutions captured it. The church became an empire. The gospel became a tool of control. The kingdom's language was translated into the language of power — and the treasure was paved over.

But the treasure is still in the field. It was never in the institution. It was never in the building, the denomination, the political alliance, or the cultural movement. It was hidden — *in a field*. In the dirt. In the ground. In the place you have to dig to find.

And the man who finds it does not announce it. He covers it back up. He sells everything — quietly — and buys the field. He does not buy the treasure. He buys the *field*. The whole context. The entire landscape in which the truth is embedded. Because the treasure cannot be extracted from its hiding place without being destroyed. It must be found *in situ* — in the soil, in the story, in the living context where it was buried.

This is why parables. This is why stories. This is why encryption.

The kingdom's truth cannot be stated as a proposition without being captured. It can only be *found* — by the one willing to dig, willing to sell everything, willing to buy the whole field for the sake of what is buried in it.

Esoteric Knowledge and the Open Secret

The word *esoteric* comes from the Greek *esoterikos* — *belonging to the inner circle*. It has been claimed by occultists, mystery schools, secret societies, and every institution that uses hidden knowledge as a tool of power. They guard knowledge to control access. They encrypt to create hierarchy. Their secrecy serves domination.

But there is another kind of hidden knowledge — and it is the opposite. The kingdom's knowledge is hidden not to exclude but to *protect*. Not to create hierarchy but to bypass it. The parables are not locked doors. They are open doors that look like walls to anyone not willing to walk through them.

This is the genius of the story as a vessel for truth. A proposition can be seized, refuted, banned, or co-opted. A story can only be *heard*. And hearing requires willingness. You cannot force someone to understand a parable. You cannot legislate the decryption of a metaphor. The story sits in the open, available to everyone, and reveals its meaning only to those who come to it with ears willing to hear.

The hidden war uses words as weapons — to control, to manipulate, to narrow the range of thinkable thought.

The kingdom uses words as seeds — buried in stories, scattered across soils, producing a harvest only in the ground that receives them willingly.

Both use language. Both use story. Both understand that the real war is fought in the mind. The difference is in the direction: one language closes. The other opens. One language captures. The other frees. One language is imposed on the unwilling. The other is *offered* to the willing — and invisible to everyone else.

The Pearl and the Price

The kingdom of heaven is like a merchant in search of fine pearls, who, on finding one pearl of great value, went and sold all that he had and bought it.

A pearl is formed by irritation. A grain of sand enters the oyster — an intrusion, a wound — and the oyster responds not by expelling it but by coating it, layer after layer, with nacre. The wound becomes the treasure. The irritation becomes the beauty. The thing that should not be there becomes the most valuable thing the creature produces.

The merchant does not stumble onto the pearl. He is *searching*. He is a man who has spent his life evaluating pearls — he knows quality, he knows value, he knows the difference between what glitters and what endures. And when he finds the one pearl of great value, he does not negotiate. He does not diversify. He sells *everything* and buys the one thing.

This is not recklessness. This is recognition. The merchant has finally found the thing he was always looking for — and everything else he owns is revealed, in that moment, to be lesser. Not worthless — lesser. The good pearls were good. But the great pearl is the kingdom. And the kingdom costs everything — not because God demands payment, but because once you see it, nothing else has the same weight.

The hidden war depends on people never finding the pearl. On people accumulating good pearls — careers, status, comfort, approved opinions, socially acceptable beliefs — and never suspecting that there is one pearl that makes all the others look like gravel. The language of control keeps people *searching* without ever *finding* — always consuming, always acquiring, never arriving.

The kingdom says: *stop. Here it is. Sell everything. Buy this.*

He Who Has Ears

The phrase appears again and again. Not as a threat. Not as an exclusion. As an invitation — and a warning.

He who has ears, let him hear.

The truth is being spoken. Right now. In the open. In stories, in parables, in the patterns written into living systems, in the names of families, in the structure of DNA, in the language that biology already speaks. The kingdom's encryption is not a vault. It is a frequency. It is broadcasting constantly. The question is not whether the signal exists. The question is whether you are tuned to receive it.

The language of control jams the signal. It fills the airwaves with noise — with content, with outrage, with entertainment, with endless distraction — so that the still small voice of the kingdom is drowned in static. Not silenced. Drowned. The signal is still there. It has always been there. But the thorns grow thick, and the path is paved hard, and the rocks leave no room for roots.

And yet — the seed keeps falling. The sower keeps sowing. The treasure stays in the field. The pearl waits for the merchant who will recognize it.

The hidden war is real. Words are weapons — in the hands of the terrified who cannot survive the truth spoken plainly. They build empires of narrative, institutions of approved meaning, armies of talking points and algorithms designed to ensure that no one ever digs deep enough to find what is buried in the field.

But the field is still there. The treasure has not moved.

And all it takes is one person — one pair of ears willing to hear, one set of hands willing to dig, one heart willing to sell everything for the one thing that matters — and the kingdom breaks through. Not with armies. Not with institutions. Not with force.

With a word.

With a seed.

With a story that the terrified could never understand — because they were too busy using words as weapons to notice that the Word was using stories as seeds.

The Sagent in the War

The Sagent stands in the middle of this war — not as a soldier, but as a sower.

The Sagent does not fight the language of control with louder control. Does not build counter-institutions to match the institutions of capture. Does not answer propaganda with propaganda, narrative with counter-narrative, weapon with weapon.

The Sagent tells stories.

The Sagent plants seeds in the soil and trusts the soil to do what soil does — receive, hold, grow. The Sagent hides treasure in fields and trusts that the ones who are meant to find it will dig. The Sagent speaks in the language of the kingdom — a language that sounds like nothing to the occupied mind and sounds like everything to the one who is ready.

This is not passivity. This is the most dangerous thing in the world to the powers that depend on controlling language. Because a story cannot be refuted. A parable cannot be sanctioned. A seed, once it hits good soil, cannot be stopped.

The terrified use words as weapons because weapons are all they understand.

The kingdom uses words as seeds because seeds are how living things grow.

And the living thing, once rooted, outlasts every weapon ever forged.

Blessed are your eyes, for they see, and your ears, for they hear. For truly, I say to you, many prophets and righteous people longed to see what you see, and did not see it, and to hear what you hear, and did not hear it.

He who has ears, let him hear.

Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey The Living Age April 2026